

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Do You Say Sorry?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	A simple "sorry" may be enough after a small accident, but not after something _____.
2	In Ghana, a journalist apologised by following _____.
3	She had to dress in _____ and apologise while kneeling.
4	She had to dress in black and apologise while _____.
5	In Pakistan, people are generally described as _____.
6	They may be _____, using humour or playfulness rather than directness.
7	Some people avoid being very _____ about an apology.
8	Russia has a tradition called _____.
9	During it, people apologise for any _____ they have caused.
10	In Korean, apologies are shaped by a complex _____.

What is the main idea of the discussion?

- A Serious apologies usually require legal or religious procedures.
- B The meaning of apology changes depending on language and culture.
- C Public figures apologise more formally than ordinary people.
- D Most countries use the same words but different body language.

What did Afia Pokua do when apologising to the King of the Ashanti tribe?

- A She offered a gift and bowed in front of his family.
- B She apologised on television to the whole country.
- C She wore black and knelt at the palace.
- D She called relatives to express regret.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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How are Pakistanis generally characterised in the discussion?

- A As emotionally open but unwilling to forgive.
- B As direct when apologising to older people.
- C As formal because apologies are socially serious.
- D As less expressive and somewhat playful.

Why might some Pakistanis put an apology inside another conversation?

- A To avoid being too openly direct about the apology.
- B To make sure the listener remembers the apology.
- C To follow a strict traditional rule about respect.
- D To show that the offence was not serious at all.

What contrast is shown between Pakistan and Korea?

- A Pakistan uses public apology rituals, while Korea avoids them.
- B Pakistan relies on silence, while Korea uses only gestures.
- C Pakistanis may avoid directness, while Korean apologies vary by relationship.
- D Pakistan treats apologies as private, while Korea treats them as religious.

What opinion does Ahsan imply about Pakistani apologies?

- A They are usually too emotional to be comfortable.
- B They often happen indirectly rather than openly.
- C They should follow a more formal language system.
- D They are less sincere than apologies in other countries.

In "this is used in formal situations", what does "this" refer to?

- A The act of bowing.
- B The phrase "Che song ham ni da".
- C The honorific system as a whole.
- D The relationship between speaker and listener.

What can be inferred about saying sorry in Korea?

- A Choosing the wrong level of formality could affect how respectful the apology sounds.
- B People apologise only to strangers or people they do not know well.
- C Bowing is more important than the words used in the apology.
- D The same apology phrase is equally suitable in every situation.

Why is Afia Pokua's story used early in the discussion?

- A To show that apologising publicly is rare in journalism.
- B To introduce how culture can shape the form of an apology.
- C To argue that traditional apologies are always more sincere.
- D To explain why kings usually require strict apology rules.

What is the overall implication of the examples?

- A A good apology depends only on choosing the correct phrase.
- B Gestures are replacing spoken apologies in many countries.
- C Apologies can involve social rules, relationships, and actions as well as words.
- D People apologise mainly because they fear public criticism.